

connection point of “John”. Thus the VF might today show files containing that term, tomorrow it might reflect new e-mails sent by that person, and then later on that day, it might display photographs tagged with that word. The VF thus becomes a container collecting all the data points that have “John” in common. This is a very powerful feature, since it can act as a much more powerful organisational feature than your traditional directories and folders.

With the aid of virtual folders, you can create containers that collect information around multiple data points. For example, you can design one that lets you view all of your files by a particular author, one that lets you see only files that are attachments, or even one that shows you all files from a particular team project. For example, one can collect every document around keywords “John” “IT” for example—and it will automatically collect and update its content to include every mail from John in IT, and so on. This can also be extended to multimedia content wherein a virtual folder build around the query of “Rock” can collate all your music files tagged under the “Rock” genre. Since these folders are in essence, virtual, the space they occupy on your hard drive is minimal—which makes them an extremely powerful tool to categorise and sort your data.

Your saved searches are also displayed on all Explorer windows on the left-hand pane—they are thus easily available. Vista ships with a few default search folders, such as “Recently Changed”, which collate all the recently-modified files.

A saved search is also saved in your Searches directory. To open a saved Search, open Windows Explorer and click Searches. Double-click the saved search from the list and Vista will repeat the search.